
Tribhuvan University
Faculty of Humanities & Social Sciences
OFFICE OF THE DEAN

Society & Technology

BCA — Semester 1 — 2019 — Answer Sheet

Subject Code: CACS102

Group A

Attempt ALL the questions. [10 × 1 = 10]

1. i) The father of Sociology is

a) Talcott Parson b) Max Weber c) Karl Marx d) August Comte

ii) Which of the following is not true?

a) Sociology is the scientific study of society.

b) Sociology is the holistic study of human culture.

c) Sociology is a value-free science.

d) Sociology contributes in social policy formulation and social planning.

iii) What are the major two schools of thought related to scope of sociology?

a) Formalistic school and Synthetic school of thought

b) Critical and specialist school of thought

c) Formalistic and critical school of thought

d) American and British school of thought

iv) Which of the following is not a unit of social life?

a) Association b) Organization c) Group d) Social Conflict

v) One's father's brother is one's

a) Fictive kin b) Affinal kin c) Consanguineal kin d) All of the above

vi) The process by which individuals learn the culture of their society is known as

a) Acculturation b) Assimilation c) Enculturation d) Accommodation

vii) What is the process by which a society transmits its values to individuals so that they can function properly as its member?

a) Personalization b) Internalization c) Socialization d) Generalization

viii) Which of the following is not true?

a) Techno-culture is diffused to fulfill the human needs.

b) Cultural appropriateness based innovations are diffused from one place to another easily.

c) Technology is often diffused from developing areas to developed ones.

d) Cultural diffusion is the universal social process.

ix) Sociology traditionally relies mainly on

a) Quantitative data b) Historical data c) Qualitative data d) All of the above

x) Which one of the following can be placed under the category of ascribed status?

a) Caste b) Class c) An engineer d) Social reformer

[10 × 1 = 10]

Answer: Answers:

i) d) August Comte — Auguste Comte (1798-1857) is widely regarded as the father of sociology. He coined the term "sociology" and emphasized the scientific study of society.

ii) c) Sociology is a value-free science. — This is NOT entirely true. While sociology aims for objectivity, complete value-freedom is debated. Max Weber argued for value-free research, but many sociologists acknowledge that some values inevitably influence research choices.

iii) a) Formalistic school and Synthetic school of thought — The Formalistic school (led by Georg Simmel)

believes sociology studies only social forms/interactions. The Synthetic school (led by Emile Durkheim) believes sociology studies all aspects of social life.

iv) d) Social Conflict — Social conflict is a social process, not a unit of social life. The units of social life are social groups, associations, organizations, communities, and institutions.

v) c) Consanguineal kin — One's father's brother (paternal uncle) is related by blood, making him a consanguineal kin. Affinal kin are related by marriage, and fictive kin are non-biological family-like relationships.

vi) c) Enculturation — Enculturation is the process by which individuals learn and adopt the culture of their society. Socialization is broader; enculturation specifically refers to cultural learning.

vii) c) Socialization — Socialization is the lifelong process through which individuals learn the norms, values, behaviors, and skills appropriate to their society, enabling them to function as members.

viii) c) Technology is often diffused from developing areas to developed ones. — This is generally NOT true. Technology typically diffuses FROM developed areas TO developing areas due to resource, infrastructure, and research advantages in developed nations.

ix) c) Qualitative data — Sociology traditionally relies mainly on qualitative data (interviews, observations, case studies, ethnography), though modern sociology increasingly uses quantitative methods (surveys, statistics) as well.

x) a) Caste — Ascribed status is assigned at birth without individual effort or choice. Caste is ascribed (born into it). Class, engineer, and social reformer are achieved statuses through effort and accomplishment.

Group B

Attempt any SIX questions. [6 × 5 = 30]

2. How does Formalistic school of thought differ from Synthetic school of thought?

[5]

Answer: Formalistic School vs. Synthetic School:

Formalistic School	Synthetic School
Led by Georg Simmel and Vierkandt	Led by Emile Durkheim and Hobhouse
Sociology studies only social forms and relationships	Sociology studies all aspects of social life comprehensively
Narrow scope — focuses on pure sociology	Broader scope — sociology is a general science of society
Emphasizes abstract forms of social interaction	Emphasizes concrete social phenomena and institutions
Excludes study of specific social institutions (family, religion)	Includes study of all social institutions and collective behavior
Considers sociology as a special social science	Considers sociology as the fundamental social science

Key Difference: The Formalistic school believes sociology should study only the forms of social relationships (how people interact), while the Synthetic school believes sociology should study the entire content of social life, including all institutions, processes, and collective phenomena.

3. Write an essay on 'relevance of sociology in computer application'.

[5]

Answer: Relevance of Sociology in Computer Applications

Sociology and computer applications may seem like unrelated fields, but they are increasingly interconnected in our technology-driven world. Understanding sociological principles is essential for developing effective, ethical, and user-centered computer applications.

1. User-Centered Design:

Sociological insights about human behavior, cultural norms, and social structures help software developers design applications that meet actual user needs. Understanding social contexts prevents designing apps that are technically sound but socially inappropriate or unusable.

2. Digital Divide:

Sociology helps identify gaps in technology access based on class, gender, age, geography, and education. Computer applications must be designed with awareness of these inequalities to ensure inclusive access.

3. Online Communities and Social Media:

Sociological theories about group formation, social influence, and collective behavior are essential for designing social media platforms, forums, and collaborative tools. Understanding how online communities form and function helps create healthier digital spaces.

4. Ethics and Privacy:

Sociology raises critical questions about surveillance, data privacy, and the social implications of AI. Computer professionals need sociological awareness to navigate ethical dilemmas around user data and algorithmic bias.

5. Technology and Social Change:

Sociology studies how technology transforms society — from employment patterns to family structures to political movements. Computer application developers benefit from understanding these impacts to create responsible technology.

Conclusion:

Sociology provides the human context that pure technical knowledge lacks. For computer applications to serve society effectively, developers must understand the social worlds in which their technologies operate.

4. Discuss the influence of modern technology in changing family relationship.

[5]

Answer: Influence of Modern Technology on Family Relationships:

Modern technology has profoundly transformed family dynamics, creating both opportunities and challenges:

Positive Influences:

- 1. Enhanced Communication:** Smartphones and video calls (WhatsApp, Zoom, FaceTime) allow family members to stay connected across geographical distances. Migrant workers can regularly communicate with families back home.
- 2. Shared Experiences:** Families can watch movies together on streaming platforms, play online games, and share photos/videos, creating new forms of family bonding.
- 3. Access to Information:** Parents can access parenting resources, health information, and educational content to better care for children.
- 4. Safety and Monitoring:** GPS tracking and mobile apps help parents ensure children's safety and know their whereabouts.

Negative Influences:

- 1. Reduced Face-to-Face Interaction:** Family members often sit together but are absorbed in individual screens, reducing meaningful conversation and emotional connection.
- 2. Generation Gap:** Younger generations are often more tech-savvy than elders, creating communication barriers and reducing respect for elder wisdom.
- 3. Addiction and Distraction:** Excessive use of social media and gaming leads to neglect of family responsibilities and relationships.
- 4. Privacy Concerns:** Technology can invade family privacy through surveillance apps and social media oversharing, creating trust issues.
- 5. Changed Gender Roles:** Technology has enabled remote work, changing traditional division of household labor, which can cause adjustment tensions in families.

Conclusion: Technology is a double-edged sword for families. Conscious, balanced use can strengthen relationships, while excessive or unmindful use can weaken them.

5. What do you understand by society? How does it differ from community? Discuss with examples.

[5]

Answer: Society:

Society is a group of people who share a common territory, culture, and social structure, and who interact with one another on a regular basis. It is a web of social relationships formed through interaction. Society is abstract, larger in scope, and includes diverse groups with varying interests.

Community:

A community is a group of people living in a specific geographical area who share common interests, values, and a sense of belonging. It is more concrete, localized, and characterized by "we-feeling" and face-to-face relationships.

Society	Community	Larger and more abstract	Smaller and more concrete	No definite locality required	Definite geographical area	Diverse interests and groups	Common interests and goals	Indirect/impersonal relationships	Direct/personal relationships	Weaker sense of belonging	Strong "we-feeling"	Example: Nepali society	Example: A village in Pokhara
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Examples:

- **Society:** The entire nation of Nepal constitutes a society with diverse ethnicities, religions, and cultures.
- **Community:** The residents of a specific neighborhood in Kathmandu who know each other, celebrate festivals together, and share local concerns form a community.

6. What is marriage and what are the various types of marriage? Describe with examples.

[5]

Answer: Marriage:

Marriage is a socially and legally recognized union between two people (traditionally a man and a woman) that establishes rights and obligations between them, their children, and in-laws. It is a universal social institution found in all societies, though its form and rules vary across cultures.

Types of Marriage:

1. Monogamy: Marriage between one man and one woman at a time. It is the most common form in modern societies.

Example: Christian marriages in Nepal and Western countries.

2. Polygamy: Marriage involving more than one spouse. It has two forms:

- **Polygyny:** One man married to multiple women.

Example: Traditional practice among some Muslim communities and certain ethnic groups in Nepal.

- **Polyandry:** One woman married to multiple men.

Example: Fraternal polyandry practiced in some Himalayan communities of Nepal and Tibet, where brothers share a wife.

3. Endogamy: Marriage within a specific social group, caste, or clan.

Example: Marriages within the same caste in traditional Hindu society.

4. Exogamy: Marriage outside one's own group, clan, or family.

Example: Prohibition of marriage within the same gotra (clan) in Hindu tradition.

5. Arranged Marriage: Marriage where families or matchmakers select partners.

Example: Common in South Asian societies including Nepal and India.

6. Love Marriage: Marriage based on mutual romantic attraction and choice of partners.

Example: Increasingly common among urban youth in Nepal.

7. What do you understand by social stratification? Discuss caste-based stratification in Nepalese society?

[5]

Answer: Social Stratification:

Social stratification is the hierarchical arrangement of individuals and groups in a society based on wealth, power, prestige, education, or other criteria. It creates structured inequality where some positions are ranked higher than others. The major systems are: caste, class, estate, and slavery.

Characteristics:

- Universal — found in all societies
- Persistent — continues across generations
- Hierarchical — ranked from high to low
- Unequal distribution of resources and opportunities

Caste-Based Stratification in Nepalese Society:

1. Historical Background:

The caste system in Nepal was formally codified by the Muluki Ain (National Code) of 1854 under Jung Bahadur Rana. It classified people into a hierarchical social order based on Hindu varna system.

2. Hierarchy:

Traditionally, the hierarchy placed Tagadhari (wearers of sacred thread — Brahmins, Chhetris, Thakuris) at the top, followed by Matwali (alcohol-drinkers — various ethnic groups), and Pani Na Chalne (untouchables — Dalits) at the bottom.

3. Discrimination:

Dalits faced severe discrimination — exclusion from temples, denial of water sources, restricted occupations (menial work), and social ostracism. Inter-caste marriage was socially punished.

4. Legal Reforms:

The 1951 revolution and subsequent constitutions abolished untouchability. The 1990 constitution and 2015 constitution explicitly prohibit caste discrimination. The Caste-Based Discrimination and Untouchability (Offense and Punishment) Act, 2011 criminalizes such practices.

5. Current Status:

While legal barriers are removed, caste-based discrimination persists in rural areas, marriage practices, and political representation. Dalits remain socio-economically disadvantaged with lower literacy rates, income levels, and political participation.

6. Government Initiatives:

Reservation quotas in education, government jobs, and legislative bodies aim to uplift marginalized castes.

8. Write Short Notes on any two:

a) Assimilation

b) Focus Group Discussion method in social research

c) Quantitative research

[5]

Answer: a) Assimilation:

Assimilation is the social process by which individuals or groups from different cultural backgrounds adopt the culture, values, and behaviors of another group, becoming integrated into the dominant culture. It involves the loss of distinct cultural identity of the minority group.

Characteristics:

- Unidirectional — minority adopts majority culture
- Involves cultural, biological, and psychological integration
- Results in homogenization of society

Example: Immigrants to the United States adopting English language, American dress, and customs while losing their native traditions.

b) Focus Group Discussion (FGD) in Social Research:

FGD is a qualitative research method where a small group of participants (6-12 people) discuss a specific topic under the guidance of a moderator. It collects diverse perspectives through group interaction.

Advantages:

- Generates rich, detailed qualitative data
- Participants stimulate each other's thoughts
- Cost-effective compared to individual interviews
- Observes group dynamics and consensus-building

Limitations:

- Dominated by vocal participants
- Groupthink may suppress dissenting views
- Not statistically representative

c) Quantitative Research:

Quantitative research is a systematic empirical investigation of social phenomena using statistical, mathematical, or computational techniques. It focuses on quantifying relationships, testing hypotheses, and generalizing findings.

Features:

- Uses structured instruments (questionnaires, surveys)
- Large sample sizes for statistical validity
- Objective, measurable data
- Seeks cause-and-effect relationships
- Results are presented numerically and statistically

Methods: Surveys, experiments, content analysis, statistical analysis

Example: A survey of 1000 Nepali youth measuring the correlation between social media use and academic performance using statistical tests.

Group C

Attempt any TWO questions. [$2 \times 10 = 20$]

9. What do you understand by National Integration? What are the major dimensions of National Integration? Discuss.

[10]

Answer: National Integration:

National integration is the process of uniting people from diverse ethnic, religious, linguistic, and cultural backgrounds into a cohesive nation with a shared identity, common goals, and mutual respect. It creates a sense of belonging to the nation above regional, communal, or sectarian loyalties.

Major Dimensions of National Integration:

1. Political Integration:

- Unification of political institutions and governance systems
- Equal representation of all regions and communities in government
- Rule of law and constitutional supremacy
- **In Nepal:** Federal system with 7 provinces aims to balance local autonomy with national unity

2. Social Integration:

- Breaking down caste, ethnic, and religious barriers
- Promoting inter-caste and inter-ethnic marriages
- Equal social status and dignity for all citizens
- **In Nepal:** Abolition of untouchability, promotion of social inclusion policies

3. Cultural Integration:

- Respecting and celebrating cultural diversity while building common national culture
- Shared national symbols (flag, anthem, constitution)
- Common festivals and national events
- **In Nepal:** Constitution recognizes all languages and cultures while promoting Nepali as lingua franca

4. Economic Integration:

- Balanced regional development to reduce economic disparities
- Equal access to resources, employment, and economic opportunities
- Infrastructure connecting all regions
- **In Nepal:** Need to address Kathmandu-centric development and uplift backward regions

5. Emotional/Psychological Integration:

- Sense of patriotism and national pride
- "We-feeling" transcending local identities
- Shared historical memory and future aspirations

Challenges to National Integration in Nepal:

- Ethnic and regional identity politics
- Economic inequality between regions
- Historical marginalization of certain communities
- Political instability and transitional justice issues

Conclusion: National integration is not about eliminating diversity but creating unity in diversity. Nepal's multi-ethnic, multi-lingual, and multi-religious character can be its strength if managed through inclusive policies and shared national vision.

10. 'A greater proportion of an individual's personality is a reflection of the type of socialization process he or she has gone through during primary socialization'. Explain.

[10]

Answer: Explanation of the Statement:

This statement emphasizes the critical importance of primary socialization in shaping an individual's personality. Primary socialization occurs during childhood, primarily within the family, and lays the foundation for all subsequent social learning.

What is Primary Socialization?

Primary socialization is the first and most crucial phase of socialization, occurring during early childhood (typically 0-5 years). It takes place within the family and close kinship network. Children learn language, basic norms, values, emotional patterns, and self-concept during this period.

How Primary Socialization Shapes Personality:

1. Language Acquisition:

The language learned during primary socialization becomes the foundation of thought, communication, and cultural identity. It shapes how individuals perceive and categorize the world.

2. Value Internalization:

Children absorb the moral and ethical values of their family — honesty, respect, hard work, religious beliefs. These values become deeply embedded and resistant to change.

3. Emotional Development:

The quality of early parent-child attachment determines emotional regulation, self-esteem, and interpersonal trust. Secure attachment leads to confident, well-adjusted adults.

4. Gender Socialization:

Family teaches gender roles through differential treatment, toy selection, and behavioral expectations. These learned gender behaviors persist throughout life.

5. Cultural Identity:

Food habits, religious practices, festivals, and customs learned in childhood become part of one's core identity. Even when people migrate, they often retain these childhood cultural markers.

6. Self-Concept Formation:

The looking-glass self theory suggests children develop self-image based on how family members treat and label them. Positive reinforcement builds confidence; neglect or abuse creates insecurity.

Why It Outweighs Later Socialization:

- Childhood learning is most impressionable (critical period hypothesis)
- Family bonds create emotional investment in learned behaviors
- Early habits become subconscious and automatic
- Later socialization (school, peer groups, media) builds upon the foundation laid during primary socialization

Conclusion: While secondary socialization (school, peers, media) continues to shape individuals, the fundamental personality structure — values, emotional patterns, self-concept, and cultural identity — is predominantly formed during primary socialization. This is why family environment is considered the most

powerful influence on human development.

11. Discuss the major data collection tools and techniques used in social research.

[10]

Answer: Data Collection Tools and Techniques in Social Research:

Social research employs various tools and techniques to gather reliable and valid data. These can be classified into primary and secondary methods.

A. Primary Data Collection:

1. Observation:

The researcher watches and records social behavior in natural or controlled settings.

- **Participant Observation:** Researcher participates in the group's activities (e.g., studying a religious cult by joining it)
- **Non-participant Observation:** Researcher observes without participating
- **Structured Observation:** Uses predetermined categories and checklists
- **Unstructured Observation:** Flexible, descriptive recording

2. Interview:

Direct verbal interaction between researcher and respondent.

- **Structured Interview:** Fixed questionnaire, standardized questions
- **Unstructured Interview:** Open-ended, conversational
- **Semi-structured Interview:** Mix of fixed and flexible questions
- **Focus Group Interview:** Group discussion guided by moderator

3. Questionnaire/Survey:

Written set of questions administered to a sample population.

- **Open-ended:** Respondents answer in their own words
- **Closed-ended:** Multiple choice, Likert scale, yes/no
- Administered through mail, online, or in-person

4. Case Study:

In-depth examination of a single case (person, group, event, or community).

- Uses multiple sources: interviews, documents, observation
- Provides rich, detailed qualitative data

5. Experiment:

Controlled investigation to establish cause-and-effect relationships.

- Laboratory experiments (controlled settings)
- Field experiments (natural settings)

B. Secondary Data Collection:

1. **Official Records:** Census data, government reports, statistical yearbooks
2. **Historical Documents:** Letters, diaries, archives, autobiographies
3. **Mass Media:** Newspapers, magazines, television content
4. **Previous Research:** Academic journals, dissertations, books
5. **Internet Sources:** Websites, databases, digital archives

Selection Criteria:

Researchers choose tools based on research objectives, available resources, nature of the study, and target population. Triangulation (using multiple methods) enhances validity and reliability.

Note: These answers are prepared for educational purposes. Students are encouraged to verify with official textbooks and course materials.